

Winning attention, losing the wallet.

An independent product marketing strategy for Battlegrounds Mobile India: how the country's most-country's most-watched battle royale closes the revenue and engagement gap with rivals that never left.

Market & competitive analysis · Primary research · Segmentation · Positioning · GTM · Metrics

The category leader by **attention** is a laggard in **revenue**, and its active base is shrinking.

BGMI has the audience. It leads the category on reach and viewership, yet monetizes at less than half the rate of its closest competitor and is losing monthly actives. This is a monetization and retention problem, not a demand problem, and it is addressable.

Demand is not the problem. The audience is already here.

Reach, viewership and brand strength are all working.

260M+

REGISTERED PLAYERS

Five years after its India launch.

930M+

ESPORTS VIEWS 2025

Up 201% year on year, an all-time high.

86.8M

UNIQUE ESPORTS VIEWERS

984M YouTube impressions across BGMI IPs.

~730K

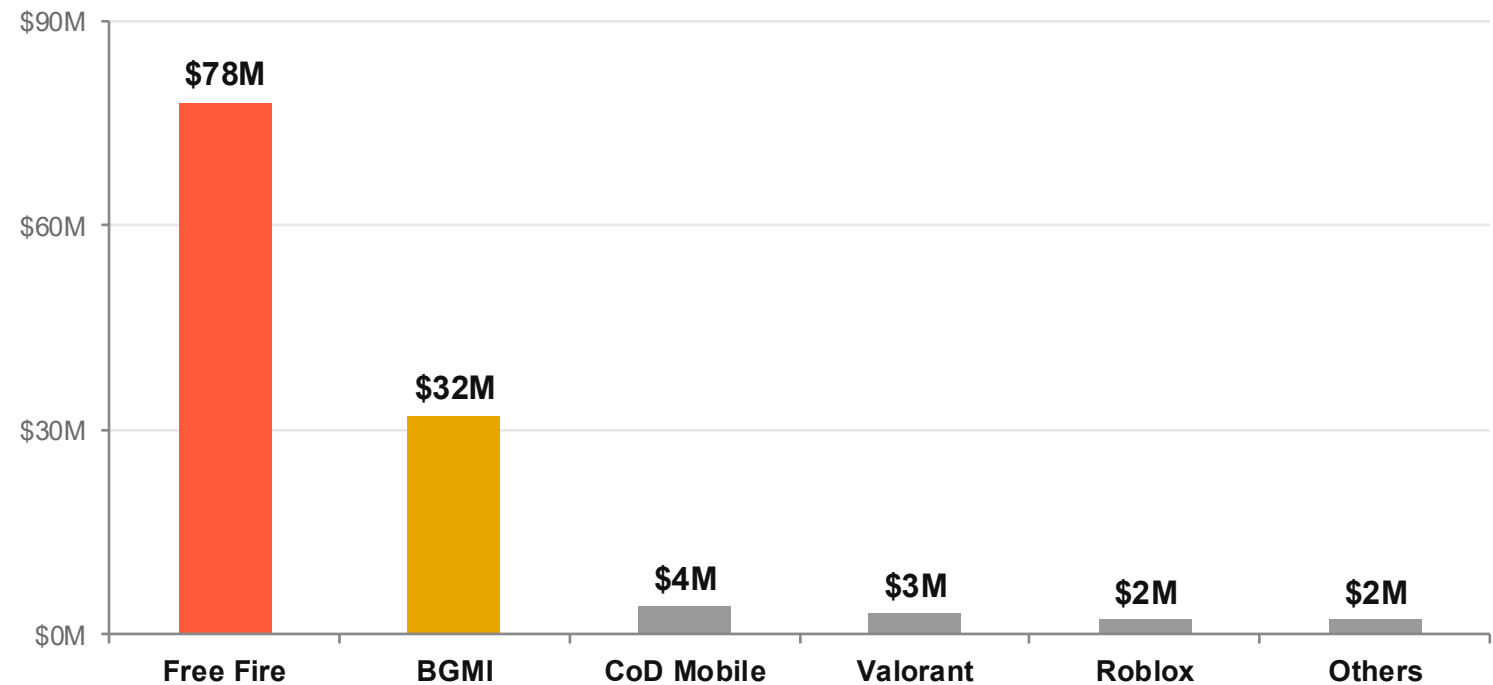
PEAK CONCURRENT, BMPS 2026

All-time BGMI record; BGIS 2026 hit ~600K.

The insight to carry: viewership is an owned, warm audience. Those 86.8M viewers include lapsed users who still follow the brand, a reactivation channel already paid for and not yet converted.

The category leader monetizes at less than half the rate of its rival.

Top-grossing India mobile titles in the category, annual revenue, Mar 2025 to Mar 2026.
Free Fire is published by Garena; BGMI by Krafton. Category share of India mobile revenue is shifting away from battle royale (Niko Partners: 53.2% to 62.8% non-BR, 2023 to 2026).



2.4x

Free Fire's revenue lead over BGMI in its home market.

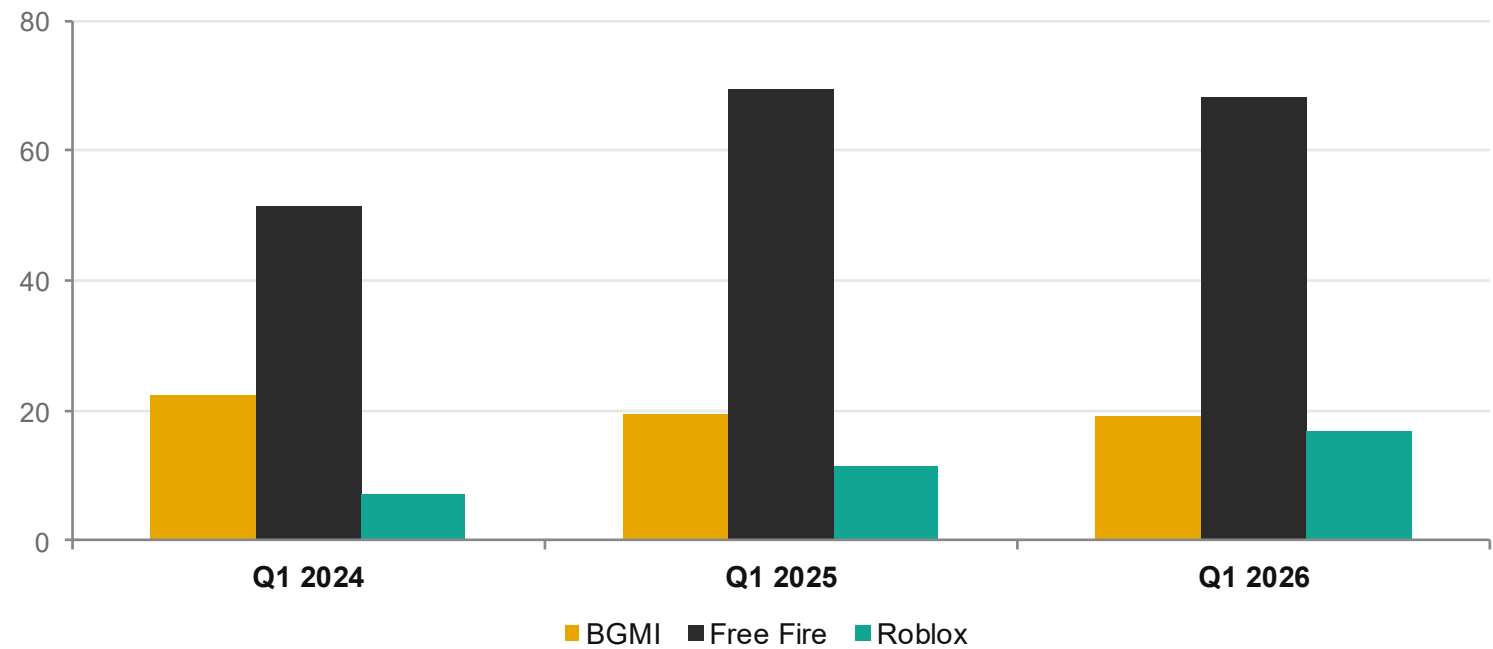
5 yrs

Free Fire has been India's number-one-grossing game, running.

It competes today through Free Fire Max. Not absent, out-earning.

The active base is contracting while substitutes grow.

Monthly active users, India, Q1 2024 to Q1 2026 (millions).
Publishers: BGMI (Krafton), Free Fire (Garena), Roblox (Roblox Corp.).



3.5x

Free Fire's monthly players versus BGMI.

19.3M

BGMI's MAU, its lowest, down from 22.4M in 2024.

Roblox: 7.1M to 16.8M in two years, closing on BGMI fast.

The higher-value audience is the one converting least.

The gap is supply-side: monetization design and offer cadence, not willingness to pay.

Why the higher-value base converts less

Accessibility. Free Fire runs on sub-\$150 phones and 1GB RAM. A far larger paying funnel.

Spend design. The rival relies on frequent, low-ticket, habitual purchases; BGMI on infrequent, high-ticket ones.

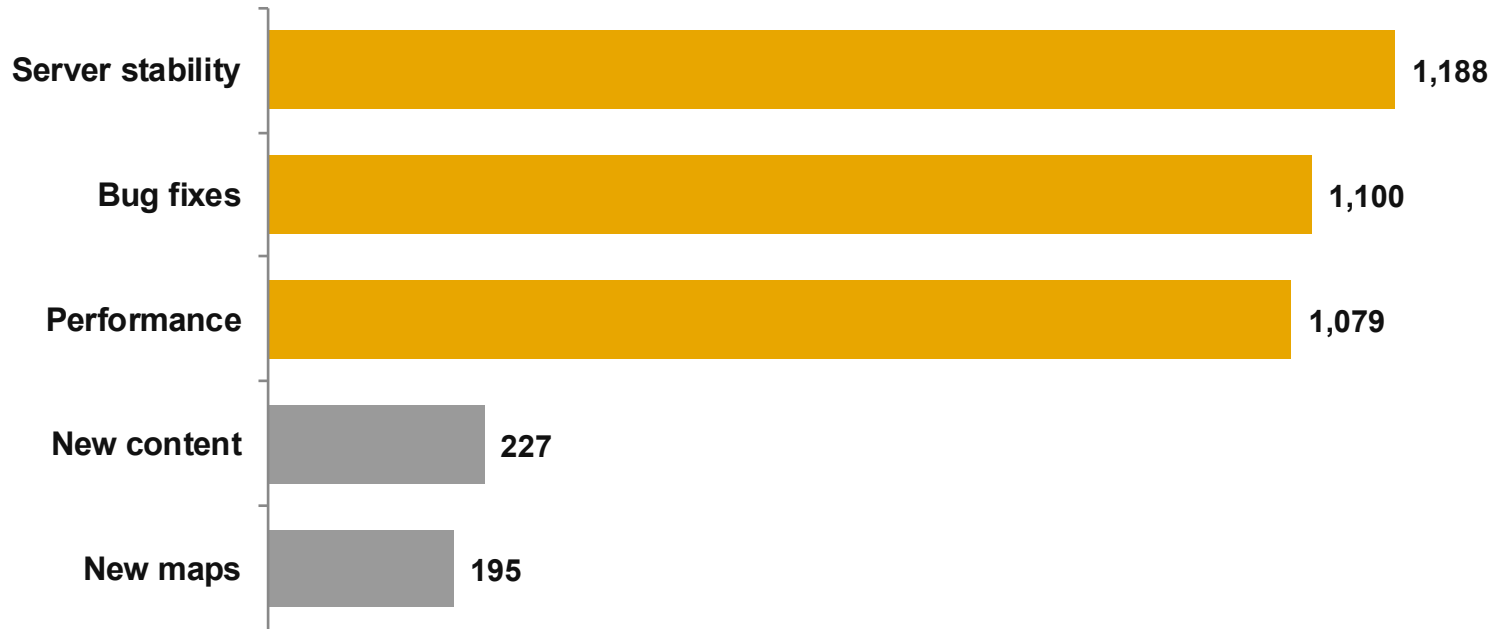
Offer cadence. The largest gap. The rival ships constant, low-priced offers; BGMI ships fewer and pricier ones.

	Player A	Player B
Phone	\$150 Android	\$700 phone
Plays	Free Fire	BGMI
Access	Easy	Easy
Capacity to pay	Lower	Higher
Actual spend	Higher	Lower

The play: Convert brand collaborations into frequent, low-ticket, UPI-native purchase moments rather than one-off drops. Grow revenue through purchase frequency and desirability, not price or advantage.

Users prioritize reliability over new content.

Primary research: 1,257-response survey plus 50 in-depth interviews. Top priority ranked.



65%

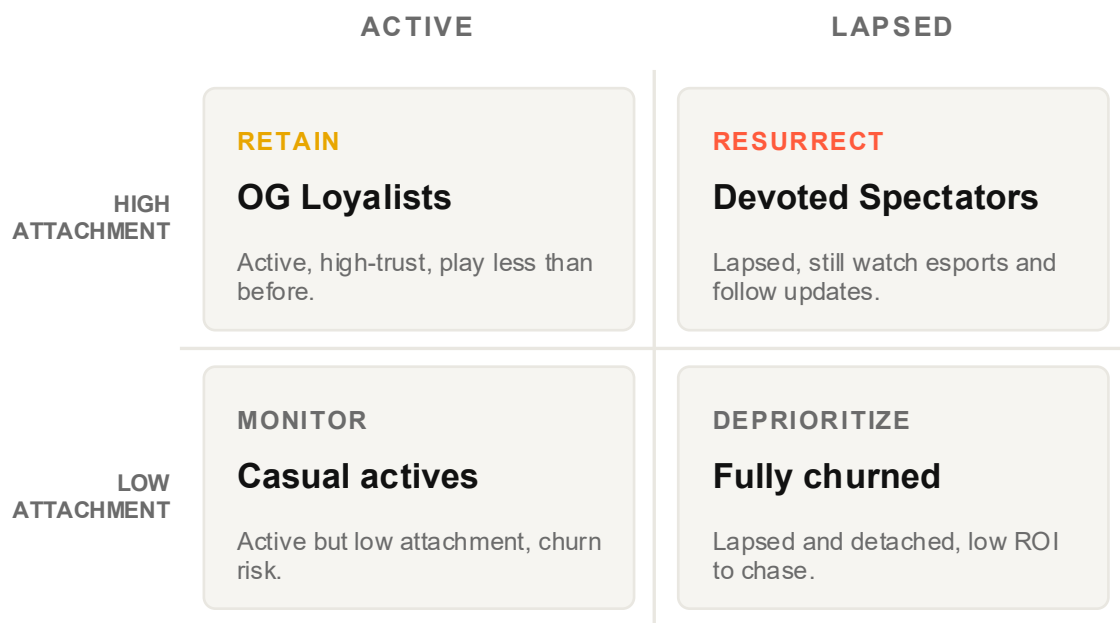
say their experience worsened over six months, 45% called it significant.

6.8 to 3.7

Satisfaction falls from no server errors to near-daily errors (10-point scale).

Two cohorts to keep, one to win back, one to recruit.

Segments built only on what the survey measured: activity and attachment.



Provenance and evidence

- 73% of the 1,257 survey respondents are daily users (the active base).
- About half of the 50 interviewees had reduced or stopped playing (the lapsed base).
- Retain and Resurrect cohorts are drawn from primary research.
- The Recruit target below is market analysis, not a survey finding.

RECRUIT Next-cohort teens (12 to 18)

Not in the survey. A prospective segment, mobile-native, drifting to Roblox and short-form. Sized by market analysis.

Three decision profiles, one per go-to-market motion.

Behavioural profiles, not demographics. Each maps to a single motion.

RETAIN

The OG Loyalist

WHO

Since the PUBG era, ranked-focused, plays less, historically a spender.

WANTS / PAIN

Competitive integrity and status; alienated by reliability decline.

MOVED BY

Visible server and anti-cheat fixes; a vintage, classic-era campaign.

THE PLAY

We fixed what you flagged.

RESURRECT

The Devoted Spectator

WHO

Stopped playing, still watches BGIS and BMPS, follows every update.

WANTS / PAIN

Left over bugs and deprioritization, not boredom. Attachment intact, trust lapsed.

MOVED BY

Credible proof it is fixed, met inside the esports they already watch.

THE PLAY

Highest-value win-back; already inside the 930M funnel.

RECRUIT

The Next-Cohort Teen

WHO

12 to 18, mobile-native, splitting time with Roblox and short-form.

WANTS / PAIN

Play with friends, create, belong; BGMI feels like an older game.

MOVED BY

Creators they follow; UGC that lets them build; low-friction entry.

THE PLAY

Recruit before Free Fire relaunch and Roblox lock them in.

BGMI is contested on two maps, not one list.

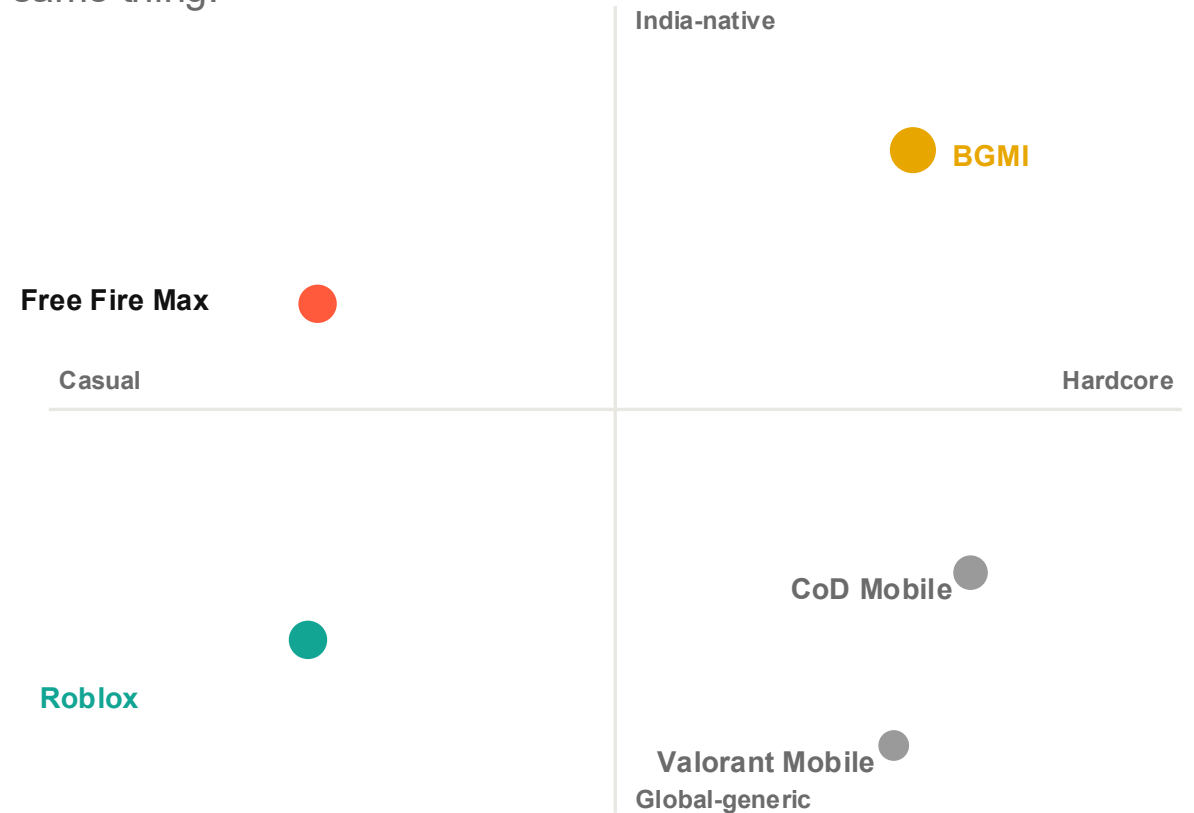
Free Fire, CoD Mobile, Valorant and Roblox do not fight for the same thing.

Arena 1, battle royale

Free Fire Max (mass-casual, the revenue rival), CoD Mobile, Valorant Mobile. Contest: the BR player and the ranked grind.

Arena 2, attention and platform

Roblox and short-form video. Contest: the next cohort's time, and the creation-platform future Krafton is already building toward.



Where each rival wins, and BGMI's counter.

	BGMI Krafton	Free Fire Max Garena	Roblox Roblox Corp.
<i>Fights for</i>	The hardcore BR player	Mass-casual BR, tier 2 and 3	The next cohort's time
<i>Core strength</i>	Esports, culture, mindshare	Monetization depth, low-end reach	UGC network, creation loop
<i>Monetization</i>	Cosmetic-only, shallower	Gacha and progression, deep	UGC economy (Robux)
<i>Where it wins</i>	Attention and prestige	Revenue per user	Under-16 engagement
<i>BGMI's counter</i>	reference point	UGC cosmetics economy, no P2W	Player-created content platform

Both counters converge on one move: an owned creator-led content economy that addresses the revenue gap and the retention leak together.

■ POSITIONING

For competitive Indian players who want a battle royale they can **trust, BGMI is the only India-native title built on competitive **integrity** and player-created **content**.**

The axis shift: stop competing on most content and biggest collabs, a race Free Fire wins and anyone can enter. Move the fight to reliability, integrity and a creation platform, where switching costs are highest and the survey says the pain actually is.

The narrative, and the evidence beneath each claim.

Three pillars, each anchored to a data point rather than a slogan.

Built to be trusted

Server stability and anti-cheat as headline commitments, not patch notes.

OG Loyalists, push: "We fixed the servers. The rank grind is back."

Proof: reliability is the number-one churn driver (survey).

India's own battleground

Local identity, local servers, local competitive scene.

Devoted Spectators, pre-roll: "The game you still watch. Now worth playing again."

Proof: 930M+ views, number one in category viewership.

A game India builds

Player-created cosmetics; creators earn; the catalogue is yours to shape.

Next cohort, Reels: "Build the skin. Wear the skin. Get paid."

Proof: the company is scaling its creation platform.

Sequence the plan: stabilize, reactivate, then grow.

A staged plan gated on reliability. Demand generation waits until the product experience is fixed.

PHASE 1

Stabilize and communicate

- Reallocate update spend toward servers, bugs, anti-cheat.
- Make the fix visible; trust is a comms job, not just an eng one.

Reliability gate before any spend

PHASE 2

Reactivate the base

- Vintage, classic-era campaign for OG loyalists and spectators.
- Creators and streamers turn it into clips, PR and social reach.

Targets Retain + Resurrect

PHASE 3

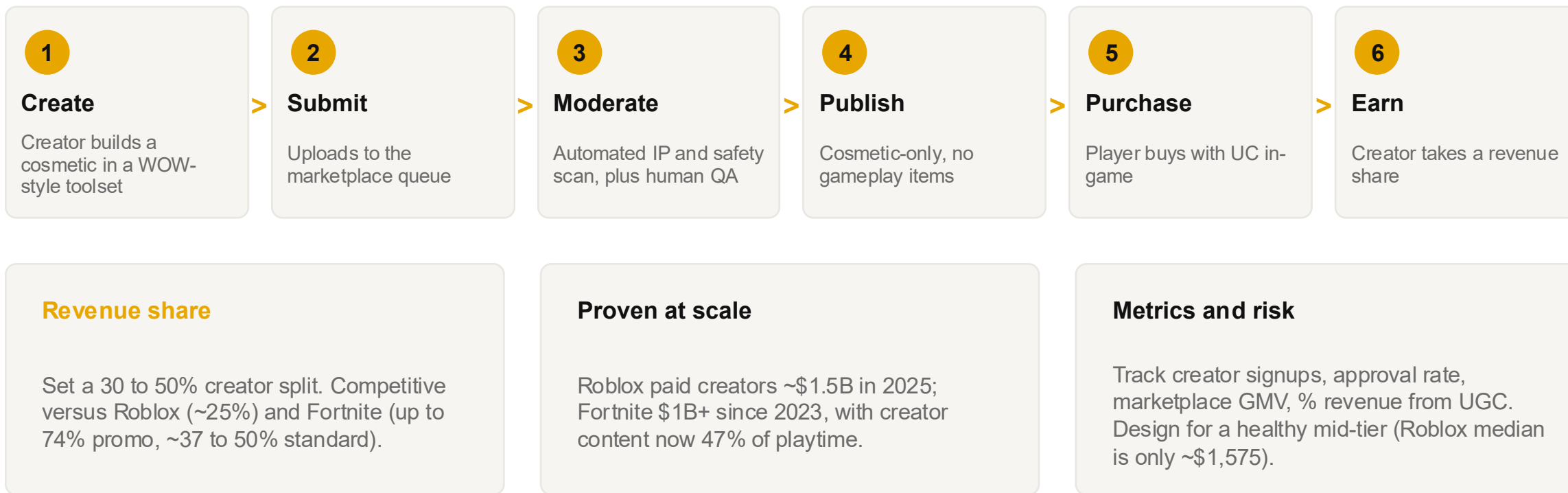
Recruit and monetize

- Recruit next-cohort teens via Instagram creator partnerships and YouTube Shorts UGC challenges.
- Convert brand collaborations into recurring, low-ticket cosmetics revenue.

Targets Recruit; closes the wallet gap

A creator-led content economy, specified for Product and Growth.

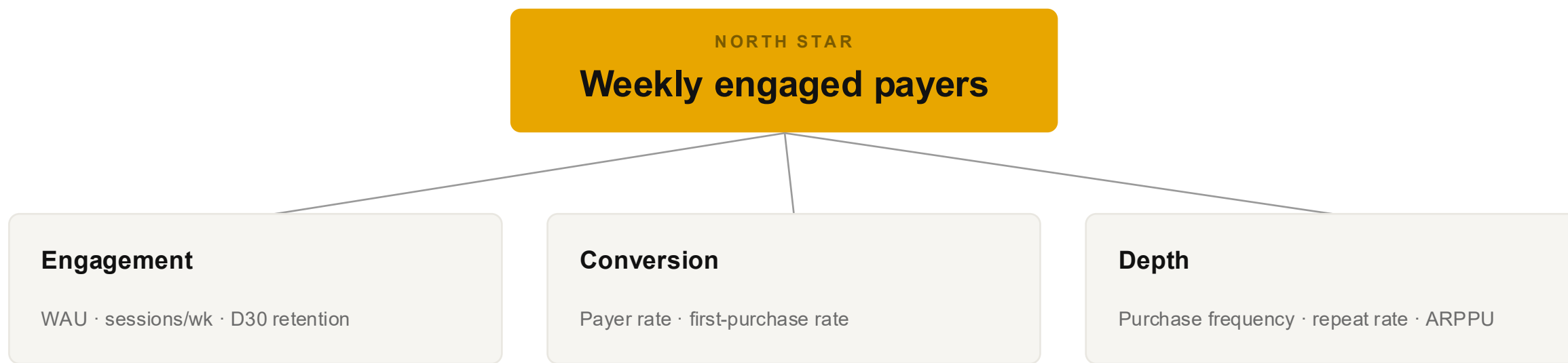
Extend the existing creation platform from levels to cosmetics. A concrete, shippable pipeline.



One North Star metric, with its inputs, not competing metrics.

Weekly engaged payers couples engagement and monetization, so neither can be gamed alone.

Definition: unique payers with at least one session and at least one purchase in a rolling 7-day window (internal telemetry). $= \text{WAU} \times \text{payer rate} \times \text{purchase frequency}$.



Why weekly, and why coupled: BGMI's gap versus Free Fire is frequency and habit, and engagement that never converts to revenue. Retained payers, conversion and ARPPU are inputs to this number, not alternative North Stars.

What BGMI should not do: chase installs, ship pay-to-win, or optimize ARPPU alone by squeezing whales.

■ RISKS AND VALIDATION

Where this fails, and how we'd know.

HONEST RISKS

- Reliability positioning is a promise the product must keep. Messaging cannot outrun the servers.
- The aging-cohort read is a hypothesis (acquisition data was unavailable). Validate before over-investing.
- A full Free Fire India relaunch could widen the revenue gap faster than the UGC economy matures.

WHAT'S NEXT

- A/B test reliability-led versus content-led messaging on win-back.
- Churn-intent model on the survey base to size the lapsed opportunity.
- Longitudinal satisfaction tracking tied to the North Star metric.
- Instrument UGC revenue per payer from day one.

> Win attention today. Convert it to the wallet before the window closes.

The end-to-end product marketing remit, demonstrated.

The domain is consumer software; the same operating model ships platform and hardware products.

Market & competitive analysis

Market sizing, two competitive arenas, and a rival-by-rival battlecard.

Primary & secondary research

A 1,257-response survey, 50 interviews, Sensor Tower and IR data triangulated.

Segmentation, targeting & personas

Behavioural segments and three decision-profile personas.

Positioning & messaging

A positioning statement and an evidence-backed messaging framework.

Go-to-market & lifecycle

A sequenced, reliability-gated retain, resurrect and recruit plan.

Monetization & business modeling

A revenue-per-user diagnosis and a shippable UGC creation economy.

Metrics & experimentation

A North Star metric, an input tree, and an A/B validation roadmap.

Executive storytelling

A data-to-recommendation narrative built for cross-functional decisions.

Every figure in this deck, sourced.

My role: I designed and led the n=1,257 survey and the 50 interviews. External figures are attributed below.

PRIMARY RESEARCH

Self-designed survey (n=1,257) and 50 interviews. Repo: github.com/naveen-raj-kanagaraj/product-analytics-user-experience

REVENUE & MARKET

Sensor Tower, India (Mar 2025 to Mar 2026); Sensor Tower State of Mobile 2026.

ENGAGEMENT (MAU)

letsgrowesports / Sensor Tower estimates, India; corroborated by BGMI lowest MAU reporting, 2026.

REGULATORY

The Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Act, 2025.

ESPORTS

Krafton India esports (2025 to 2026); BMPS 2026 and BGIS 2026 peak viewership (Esports Charts, The Wire).

COMPANY STRATEGY

Krafton FY2026 Q2 & 1H earnings: platformization, World of Wonder (5.4M+ maps), IP collaborations.

UGC PRECEDENTS

Roblox and Epic (Fortnite / UEFN) creator-payout disclosures, 2025 to 2026.

METHODOLOGY NOTE

MAU figures are third-party estimates. Player A and B are illustrative device-and-spend archetypes, not survey respondents.